the Renaissance

What is it

- cultural and intellectual movement that took place in Europe
- **14th to 17th** centries
- Started in **italy**
- **Renaissance** = **revival, rebirth**
- refers to the **revival of the anicnet greco-roman civilization**
- Innovated + carried forward the classical civilization
- laid the foundation of modern europe
- **transitional period** from medieval times to modern times

Features

Revival

- revive of the anicnet greco-roman civilization
- Studied and applied **theories and art styles** to their works

Humanism

- X God-centered
- Concerned with **Worldly Affairs**
- Humans = center of the universe
- Have independent thinking
- Develop capacities
- = **Humanism**

Challenging tradition

- Stressed the sprit of **inquiry** and **humanism**
- **Challenged** traditional idea and church teachings

- Scientific **discoveries and inventions** were made

***Causes* of the Renaissance**

Decline of feudal society

- pleasents left manors and lived in towns
- -> freeman -> greater freedom and time for art and learning
- -> Renaissance

Spread of eastern knowledge

- Arab know more than European
- Crusades (11-13 centries) encouraged knowledge exchange between Europe and Arab world
- Brought legacies of ancient civilizations
- Borden horizon + **Revived intrest** in Greco-Roman art and learning

Rise of welthy city states

- Ports and towns developed rapidly
- Italian city-states became major trading centers between Europe and Asia

Rise of welthy class

- Wealthy personel emerged in Italy and other european countries
- Concerned with worldly life
- Had money to support art and science

Rise of universities

- Goverment / merchants built universities since the 12 century
- Education **not** only controlled by church
- Universities taught subjects other than bible
- e.g. medicine law phyilosophy
- Kept **bookes about ancinet Greco-Roman civilization**
- -> people find more abt it

Deline of church influence

- Gained knowledge -> questioned the teachings of the church
- Weakened the influence of the church
- Crusades fail -> undermined the prestiege of the Church
- Rulers refused to pay tax and defied the pope

Birthplace and developement

Birthplace

- Started on the **Italian Penisula** (also the birthplace of ancient Roman civilization)
- Preserved many Roman legacies
- Had rich city-states
- Welthy supported the work of artists and scholars

Literature

- Literature Before Renassance
    - related to religon (eg biographs of saints, paryers and hymns) + written in latin
    - Only preists and scholars can read and compose
- Literature After Renassance: Wrote about **people, affairs and things**
- wrote poems, novels and plays
- Many wrote in their native language
- Literature -> **popular**

Poems

- Representative: Dante
- Wrote Divine Comedy in latin about traveling to heaven and hell -> social inequality

Novels

- Representative: Boccaccio
- Wrote Decaneron about young people taking about wrongdoings of church and man

Plays

- **Representative**: Shakespeare
- The most representative playwright
- wrote many famous plays in **english** exploring different aspects of human life

Art

Paintings

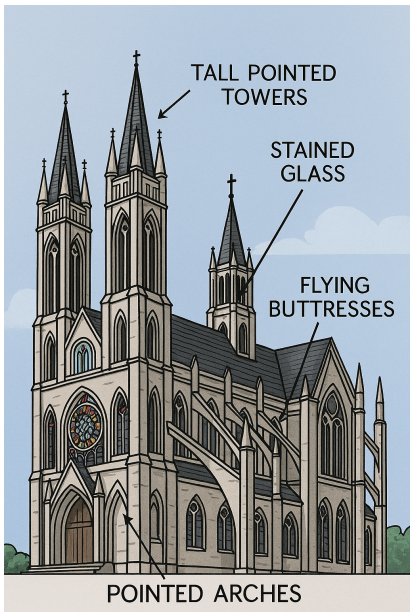
- Medieval time
  - Mainly about religon
  - **Not realistic**
- Renassance
  - Had diverse themes
  - more 3d and have perspective and shadowing
  - Studied human body to paint lifelike human body and facial expressions
  - Painters
    - Leonardo da vinci
      - Use perspective
      - e.g. mona lisa, last supper
    - Michelanngelo
      - Detalied body movements and facial expressions
      - e.g. Last judgements
    - Raphael
      - harmony, joy, happiness
      - e.g. School of Athens
  - Known as three master artists

Sculptures

- Medieval
  - Religon
- Renassance
  - Still from bible
  - but more **facial expression and body movement** <- humanism
  - famous for **realism**

Architecture

- Medieval
  - Gothic (German) style
  - Tall pointed towers, Pointed Arches , flying buttresses and stained glass



- Renassance
  - stone pillars, pediments, semi-circular arches and domes
  - Colonnades(rows of colloms) were built around plaza

Natural science development

- Before Renassance
  - Church translated many ancient science **classic** and intergrated them with **theory** to explain the universe

    - e.g. geocentrism (earth center)
    - claimed **diseases were God's punishments**
    - **prohibited dissecion** of the 'scared' human body
- During renassance
    - scholars studied the **original copies**
    - found **difference form church translation**
    - Verified theories with **observation and research**
    - known as 'scientific enquiry'
- Discoveries in **Medicine**
    - **Fracastoro**: diseases ware spread by **bacteria** (bread on decayed matter)
    - **Vesalius**: Dissected human bodies, **described** human skeleton, organs and muscles in his book
- Discoveries in astronomy
    - **Copernicus**: Proposed the theory of heliocentrism -> sun (helio) is the center of the universe
    - **Galileo**: made **telescopes** to observe the universe + carried out experiments and affirmed heliocentrism

Influence of the Renaissance

Laying out foundations for modern Europe

- Renaissance: revived the ancient Greco-Roman civilization
- made great achievement and developed rapidly
- laid the **Foundation** for moderm European civilization

Rise of humanistic education

- **Aim** of education is not clergy(e.g. pope) but 'renassance man'
- people went to **non church school** to get worldly knowledge
- -> develop European education and culture

Intellectual liberation (the process of freeing the mind)

- Renassance **freed** teh minds of Europeans
- NO longer **obeyed traditional authority blindly**
- valued **rational thinking**
- led to **Reformation**, voyages of discovery, the scientific revolution and the elightenment
- milestones in the rise of modern europe, starting in Renassance

The Reformation

- Religious movement in the 16th - 17th centuries
- Included the **split of the Church**
- **Changed European traditions**

Background

Christians **questioning** the Church

- Studied and emended (correcting errors) the early copies of the Bible
- Found **inaccuraties in Latin Bible**
- Church has misinterpreted some Christian **doctrines**(信條，教義，學說)
- In 1516 dutch theologian **Erasmus** published the original greek version of the **new testament**
- Europeans subsequently found out more misinterpretations made by the church

Rulers discontent

- Medieval
    - Church had great influence on politics
- Late Medieval (renassance)
    - Strong kings emerged
    - discontenedwith the Church and wanted to regain their powers

Wrongdoings of the Church

- Late Medieval

    - Church mecame corrupt
    - ran casinos and sold '**indulgences**' (-> reduce sufferings of the purchasers and their relatives in purgatory)
    - **Set off reformation**

Development of the Reformation

Immediate cause: selling of indulgences

- Church sold massive **indulgences** to raise money for building St. Peter's Basilica
- Some clergy exaggerated the function of indulgences
- Angered many German theologians

Martin Luther and the Ninety-Five Thesis

- **German priest** Martin Luther posted the 'Ninety-Five Theses' on a cathedral
- stressed that people could only be redeemed through faith in god
- criticized the corruption of the Church and priests
- Raised the issue of indulgences for discussion
- Wrote **Ninety-five thesis in latin and translated to German** + spread throughout german
- Further translated into different languages -> strong reactions of people in europe -> **The Reformation**

Rise of the protestant Church

- Action hindered the **revenues of indulgences** and the Church's **pristege**
- Martin Luther was later **excommunicated** from the Church
- **German people and nobles supported him**
- -> he set up a new sect Lutheranism
- Other sects including the Calvinism and Anglican Church were established
- ↑ Known as Protestantism
- Rulers even withdrew from the Roman Catholic Church
- made Protestamtism their official religons

Counter Reformatiom

- To **restore its prestige**
- to **surpress the Protestent Church**
- Carried out **reforms**
- Rulers who still follow the church are granted **more autonomy**
- **Banned** the sales of **indulgences**
- Recognised some **societies** to promote its image

Impact of the reformation

Conflicts and war

- Split christianity into Roman Catholic Church and the Protestant Church
- Led to **political instability**
- -> **thirty years war**: first great war in modern Europe

Changing the outlook of Europe

- Political
  - **Weakened** Roman Catholic Church
  - Rulers split religon from politics
  - and regained power from the Church
  - established **Absolute rule**
- Economic
  - Protestantism, like humanism, stressed worldly life
  - Glorify god by working hard
  - **favourited the developement of Europe** (especially in protestant countries)
- Intellectual and social aspects
  - Protestantism advocated religious tolerance and freedom
  - Encouraged public meetings

- showed the **ideological seeds of liberaty and democracy** in Modern Europe
- Protestant church used education as a **way to preach**
- Built schools and taught in relatively simple langauges
- Taught **new subjects** e.g. natural science
- Became more **popular** in Europe and education standard of Europeans improved